



digital CE products, CELF was established in 2003 by eight major consumer-electronics companies: Panasonic, Sony, Hitachi, NEC, Philips, Samsung Electronics, Sharp and Toshiba.

As part of this merger, the Linux Foundation will expand its technical programmes in the embedded-computing space.

CELF will become an official work-group of the Linux Foundation.

Members of CELF who are not already Linux Foundation members can be grandfathered into the organisation at the Silver membership level. The Linux Foundation will take over the management of CELF's technical events and Web infrastructure.



Nokia to ship MeeGo device in 2011

Nokia, which has so far been tight-lipped about a MeeGo-based Nokia N9 smart-phone, said it would start shipping its first MeeGo device in 2011. Speaking during a conference call, Nokia CEO Stephen Elop described the MeeGo smart-phone as 'a 2011 event', without divulging any product details. MeeGo, a Linux-based open source mobile operating system project, combines Nokia's Maemo and Intel's Moblin OS. Intel also recently announced that MeeGo phones and tablets are in the works, and would arrive by next year.

OpenOffice.org Council members resign

Following the call that OpenOffice.org Council members who had affiliated themselves with The Document Foundation (TDF) and its alternative Libre Office project should resign due to a conflict of interest, Christoph Noack, former OpenOffice.org product development representative; Florian Effenberger, former OpenOffice.org marketing project lead and German marketing contact; and Thorsten Behrens, co-project lead on the Graphic System Layer, have resigned from the OpenOffice.org Council.

Linus Torvalds recognised with 2010 C&C Prize

The Linux Foundation recently announced that Linux creator and Linux Foundation Fellow Linus Torvalds is one of three recipients of the prestigious C&C Prize in 2010. Torvalds is being recognised for his "...contributions to the advancement of the information technology industry, education, research, and the improvement of our lives," according to NEC C&C Foundation.

"Linux is the fabric of computing today, and represents one of the strongest technologies to emerge over the last century," said Jim Zemlin, executive director at The Linux Foundation. "Linus' sustained commitment to Linux and his contributions to technology innovation are valued more than ever," he added.

The C&C Prize was established in 1985, and is awarded to distinguished persons in recognition of outstanding contributions to R&D activities and pioneering work related to the integration of computers and communications technologies, and the social impact of developments in these fields.

Firefox celebrates sixth birthday

Open source Web browser, Firefox, recently celebrated its sixth birthday. Mozilla first launched the popular browser on November 9, 2004, as a "more robust, user-friendly, and trustworthy Web experience."

Firefox is now available in 70 different languages, and is used by about 400 million people worldwide. Firefox 4, the latest iteration, was originally scheduled to be launched by the end of 2010. Recently, it was announced that it has been delayed to early 2011. Mozilla is packing Firefox 4 with every weapon that it can think of, to help it decimate Microsoft's IE9. Firefox 4 comes with improvements like: HTML5 support, a better UI, multi-touch functionality, hardware-acceleration for HD video playback, support for add-ons through the Jetpack extension management API, the 'tabs on top' layout, the integration of Firefox Sync, and various other features aimed at Web developers.

Russia to develop state-funded Linux-based software

The Russian government is going the open source way to reduce and possibly even reverse its heavy Windows dependency, and to revamp its computer services. Moscow will earmark 150 million roubles (\$4.9 million) to develop a national software system based on Linux. Similar concerns about achieving technological independence prompted the Russian military to create the GLONASS satellite navigation system in the 1980s, to compete with the US Global Positioning System (GPS) and, in the future, with Europe's Galileo.